

Tobias Treppmann

Ten years developing people who were under no obligation to listen

CONTACT

LOCATION

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Developing people

A decade mentoring and coaching without line authority · a levelling framework across two disciplines · growth plans and level requirements · performance reviews · a lean 360 designed and run as a workshop · hiring, promoting and managing exits

Shared leadership

Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator, held and served · governance meetings run · Holacracy Intensive Training qualification, 2021 · personnel and process authority held separately by design · senior leadership team member

Leadership practice

M.A. Leadership, Kairos University · collaborative leadership coaching practice · design-thinking training for executive leadership · changing the conditions rather than managing the person · coaching through broken cross-functional relationships

Context

Fifteen years leading design in B2B SaaS, enterprise analytics and broadcast · teams across Germany and New York · six countries under GDPR and church data-protection law · native German, C2 English

PROFILE

M.A. in Leadership, and a decade mentoring and coaching alongside every job I have held. The people I developed at CareerFoundry and the Interaction Design Foundation did not report to me and could have stopped listening at any point. As a team lead I built the instruments rather than improvising them: a levelling framework across two disciplines, growth plans, performance reviews, and a 360 I ran as a workshop. I held the Secretary and Facilitator roles under Holacracy at Hypoport and ran governance meetings, so shared leadership is a model I have operated inside a constitution rather than read about. Native German, Berlin.

A decade, no authority

mentoring people who did not report to me and could have stopped listening

Geteilte Führung, served

Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator at Hypoport, governance meetings run

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Head of Product Design, and product manager and product owner for the redesign.
- Fifteen years of design leadership is the context this application sits in rather than the argument for it.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Led all product design across the company, and held product management for the main platform alongside it.
- Six countries under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic data-protection law, with Landeskirchen as public-law customers.
- Six countries, one platform.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Nine people at the peak, across four disciplines — design, UX writing, product management and data science — for four months, on the senior leadership team. Five as the steady state.
- Developed a levelling framework covering design and UX writing. Two disciplines, which is the part most teams with writers on them never solve.
- It set clear expectations per level, and I used it for growth plans so a junior designer and a junior writer could see what reaching the next one required.
- Ran performance reviews. Hired two and promoted two.
- Building talent was the point of the framework. Growth plans named what reaching the next role required, and I hired the consultant who then filled the Head of Product role permanently.
- Designed a lean 360 as a workshop rather than a survey, so the feedback happened in a room between the people it was about.
- An engineer was being sidelined in meetings. I changed how the meetings ran — pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking.
- That engineer became one of the strongest contributors. The conditions were the problem, not the person.
- Coached a team lead through a working relationship that had broken down with a counterpart in another function.
- Agile delivery in a matrix organization — designers assigned across product teams, with the design function held centrally.
- Two disciplines, one framework.
- Two hires. Two promotions.

Product and UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared service center of the listed Hypoport SE, run under Holacracy) · Berlin, Germany

- Held the Secretary and Facilitator roles under Holacracy, and ran governance meetings.
- Holacracy is a matrix organization with the authority written down, and I had confidence operating in it because I had been trained to run it.
- Governance meetings are where roles get created, accountabilities move and circles are restructured — the structure editing itself, on the record.
- Qualified for both: Holacracy Taster, then the Intensive Training with the Facilitator and Secretary Qualification, 2021.
- Personnel authority and process authority sat with different roles by constitutional design — the same split Toll Collect runs between fachliche Leads and People Leads.

- Ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams, and partnered with the group executive team on turning services into a product catalog.
- Secretary and Facilitator. Both held, both qualified.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and New York for five years. Two time zones, and the development conversations happened over video long before that was normal.
- Five years of enterprise software under regulation, for banks and insurers in three countries.

ALONGSIDE ALL OF IT

Two tracks have run in parallel for a decade. This one is the people work, and it is the track this role is about.

Senior Mentor, CareerFoundry · Mentor, Interaction Design Foundation

2016 – 2026

A decade developing people who had no obligation to listen to me. None of them reported to me and none of it ran on positional authority. Sustained one-to-one relationships over months — goals, feedback, and the honest conversation about what someone is not yet ready for. This is the part of leading people I have done longest.

Oratio&Co

Ongoing

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig · inside a product triad, 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA